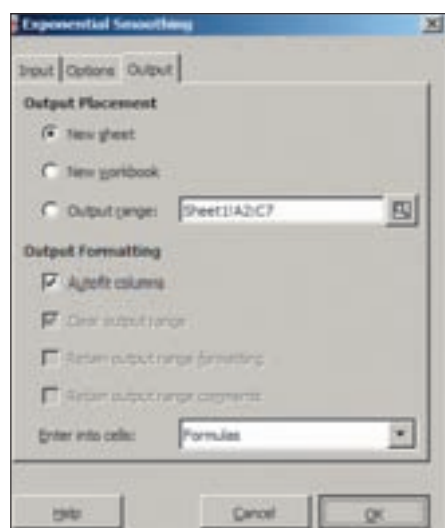


a worksheet, right-click on the worksheet, and select Remove. Although the help manual says that this operation cannot be undone, it can, so don't worry about loss of data when you are doing this. It is also a good idea to allocate custom names to worksheets, to manage a large number of worksheets, or to avoid confusion. Double-click on a worksheet, and enter text to rename it.

Statistical analysis

Some advanced functionality is included by default in Gnumeric, through the menu, which would involve entering complex formulae in other worksheets. This feature of Gnumeric makes it popular in the scientific community, and is particularly useful to mathematicians, scientists and statisticians. The Tools>Statistical Analysis has a range of options to choose from. We will show an example of the Forecast function. Go to Tools>Statistical Analysis>Forecast>Exponential Smoothing. There are five smoothing approaches available, and configured by default. Select one of these, and remember to toggle between the column and row radio button, depending on how your worksheet is laid out. You can tweak the input in the Input tab. The Options tab has error correction and factor options with reference to the



Automatically analysing data

operation. Check the Include Chart checkbox in this tab if you also want the operation to be charted. The Output tab lets you choose the output location. The safest location is a new worksheet, which is the one selected by default. Click on OK. A new worksheet should be created, with a neat table, headers and a chart if you have chosen to include one.

Freeze panes

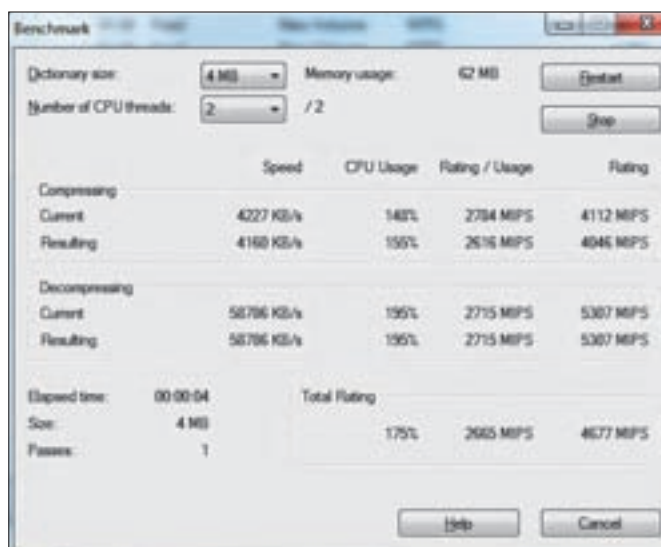
When working with a large amount of data, it is convenient to have the header rows always displayed, irrespective of how far into the worksheet you have scrolled. This avoids the need to scroll back to the top of a worksheet to find out which header a particular data entry comes under. To do this, select the header row by clicking on the appropriate section head number, or simply select the cells that you want to freeze. Then go to View > Freeze Panes. You can do this for rows as well as columns, and at the same time. Select the row or the column, and go to View > Unfreeze Panes to remove the freezing. Doing this without selecting any row or column will unfreeze all the Panes in the worksheet.

7zip

7zip is an open source compression tool developed for the Windows operating system. The utility supports decompression of almost every compression format available and it can also compress to 7z, Zip, and some others. It's a good free alternative to commercial packages such as WinZip and WinRAR.

Quickly accessing folders

For folders that you need to access quickly, 7zip has a favourites option where you can bookmark up to ten



7zip's benchmark feature in action

separate folders. Adding folders is done by first accessing the folder in 7zip, then clicking on the Favorites > Add folder to Favorites as, and then selecting a slot. Accessing the folders is done similarly using the same menu. Keyboard shortcuts such as Alt + (Number) can also be used to open the folder.

Using the flat view

The flat view is a way of viewing files in 7zip where all the contents of the subfolders are displayed within the root folder. This way, you don't have to go looking through all the subfolders looking for a specific file. The flat view can be toggled by clicking on View > Flat View.

Benchmarking your PC

Compressing files is a highly CPU intensive task that also requires a lot of memory. Really high compression levels can stress components, so it makes a good benchmark. You can use it to compare the performance of different computers and it is used by some test labs. The benchmark utility can be run using the Tools menu. The dictionary size option will affect the memory consumption of 7zip.

Selecting files by format

Selecting files in an organized

folder can be difficult. If you need to compress files of a particular format, then you have to select them separately. 7zip has a unique feature that automatically lets you select all file formats of a kind. Click on a file of a particular format, then click on Select by Type. Similarly, you can select all the files and then deselect certain formats by clicking on Edit > Deselect by Type.

7zip as a file manager

7zip can be used with a 2-pane configuration which offers better flexibility. Files can be dragged and dropped between two separate folders. 7zip has many more features that make it a very good file manager alternative to Windows Explorer. Files can be copied and moved using the function key shortcuts [F5] and [F6]. There's even a feature to add comments for files which can be handy if you have too many similarly named files.

Compress using a single core

When 7zip compresses files, it uses all the available cores. This may affect the performance of other applications running at the same time. To reduce the load, you can allot the number of processors that 7zip is allowed to use. The window that is used to create an archive has an option Number of CPU threads. For example, if you